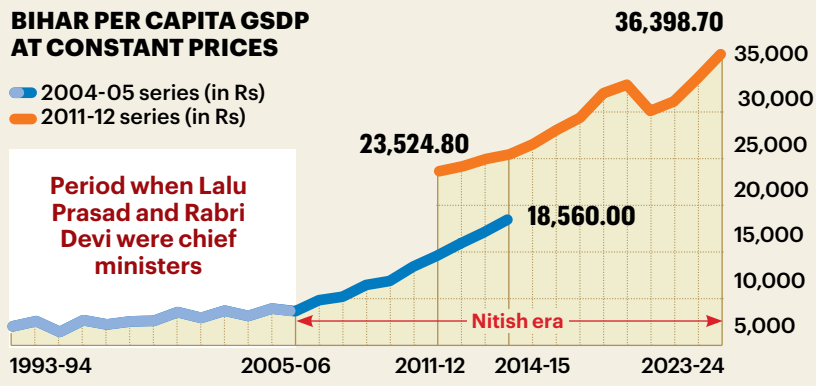
# A STEADY PUSH

**Bihar may be the poorest state by per capita income, but it's also the second fastest growing by GSDP**




Source: TCPD and CMIE data

**₹66,828**
Per capita income in FY24; in FY05, it was ₹ 7,914

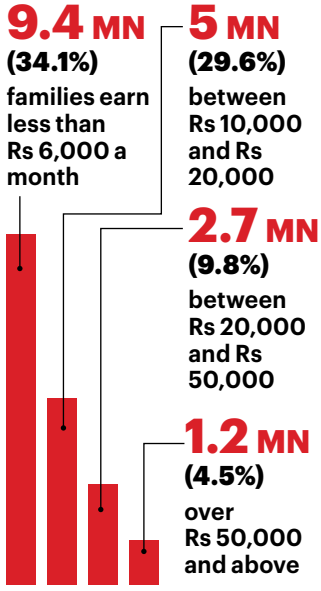
**4.93%**
Percentage of people who have a job in Bihar: 1.57% (govt), 1.22% (pvt, organised) and 2.14% (pvt, unorganised)

**8.64%**
Bihar's growth rate in 2024-25 at constant prices (2011-12)

Source: Bihar Economic Survey, NITI Aayog, PIB

# PRISONERS OF POVERTY

**A vast majority of families in Bihar are teetering on the edge**




Source: Bihar Caste Survey, 2023

## Anti-Incumbency Focus

The MGB's campaign revolves around anti-incumbency and frustration with Nitish's long tenure. Tejashwi is the face of a '*nayi soch*' (new thinking), even as the RJD has gone through a caste recalibration, with non-Yadavs occupying important posts. The Opposition narrative blends emotional recall—'justice and dignity'—with material pledges: jobs, expanded quotas, financial aid for women and housing subsidies.

Behind the scenes, Tejashwi's team has professionalised the RJD's campaign machinery, drawing on social media agility and data analytics. His Dalit outreach on October 5 was emblematic—a pitch for inclusivity but also a push to broaden the support base. Yet, whether these gestures can undo entrenched perceptions of the RJD's past remains uncertain.

The MGB's talking points revolve around unemployment, inflation, education and corruption. The Opposition also frames the BJP's dominance as centralisation, arguing that Bihar's autonomy is being diluted under the garb of 'double-engine' governance. As for the constant taunts of 'Jungle Raj', the young scion has declared, "*Tejashwi ki parchhai bhi agar galat kaam kare, toh uspe karyavaahi hogi* (even my shadow will be investigated if it has done wrong)."

## The SWOT Analysis

**STRENGTHS: Tejashwi's youth appeal, emotional resonance of social justice politics, renewed organisational verve and, of course, the solid Muslim-Yadav vote bank**

**WEAKNESSES: Overdependence on Tejashwi; limited inroads beyond M-Y base; friction among allies on seat-sharing. Congress stays its weakest partner**

**OPPORTUNITIES: Anti-incumbency sentiment; mobilisation of first-time voters; capacity to fuse national INDIA bloc momentum with state grievances. PK slicing off part of NDA votes may also help RJD**

**THREATS: RJD's legacy stigma; third-party disruptions that nibble at anti-NDA votes**